

PAVAN KUMAR NAYAKANTI

SRE & Platform Engineering Leader | SLI/SLO | Observability | Chaos Engineering | Multi-Cloud | Regulated FinTech

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Hyderabad, India

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior SRE and Platform Engineering leader with 22 years owning reliability programmes for FinTech and banking platforms - ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, and RBC. Defines and enforces SLI/SLO frameworks, architects full-stack observability stacks (Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, Splunk), and builds blameless postmortem cultures that deliver 40%+ MTTR reduction. Scaled SRE organisations from 4 to 40 engineers across three continents, governing 24x7 on-call operations, CI/CD pipelines with feature flag-driven release controls, and IaC delivery (Terraform, AWS CDK, CloudFormation) for multi-product B2B platforms. Every client engagement operated under SOX, GDPR, and banking-grade regulatory constraints - the same reliability requirements as regulated InsurTech SaaS.

CORE COMPETENCIES

SLI/SLO Definition & Error Budgets

Full-Stack Observability (Prometheus | Grafana | Dynatrace | Splunk)

Incident Management & Blameless Postmortems

CI/CD Pipeline Engineering (Jenkins | GitLab | Ansible)

Infrastructure as Code (Terraform | AWS CDK | CloudFormation)

24x7 On-Call Governance & MTTR Reduction

Multi-Team SRE Leadership at Enterprise Scale

Chaos Engineering & Self-Healing Platform Design

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & DevOps

AWS (ECS Fargate, Lambda, CDK, CloudFormation, VPC, ALB), Microsoft Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Terraform, Ansible, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, GitLab, GitHub Actions

Observability & AIOps

Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, Splunk, AppDynamics, MS Application Insights, Telegraf

Reliability Engineering

SLI/SLO, Error Budgets, Chaos Engineering (Keptn), Self-Healing Frameworks, ITIL, ServiceNow

Automation & Scripting

Python, Ansible, Bash, PowerShell, Go, Groovy, CI/CD Orchestration

DevSecOps

SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory, SAST/DAST/IAST, UrbanCode Deploy, Shift-Left Security, SOX/GDPR CI/CD

AI / ML

GenAI (AWS Bedrock, Azure OpenAI), AIOps, MLOps, AI-102, DP-100

WORK EXPERIENCE

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Practice & SRE Lead

Sep 2020 - Present

IRIS Software | India

Clients: ADP | Charles Schwab | BMO Financial Group

SRE and platform engineering lead across three major banking clients - owning SLI/SLO governance, full-stack observability, on-call operations, chaos engineering, and engineering org buildout at enterprise scale.

SRE & RELIABILITY ENGINEERING

- Defined and governed SLIs and SLOs across multi-client platforms (ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO) - established error budgets, reliability thresholds, and quarterly burn-rate reviews aligned to business SLAs.
- Deployed full-stack observability: Prometheus + Grafana for infrastructure metrics, Dynatrace for APM, Splunk for log aggregation - enabling correlated real-time alerting and proactive root cause analysis.
- Led incident response and blameless postmortem programme for ADP SRE - automated remediation via Ansible and Python, structured RCA workflows, and cross-team postmortem cadence, cutting MTTR by 40%+.
- Defined 24x7 on-call rotations and escalation frameworks for a 35-member SRE team across India, Canada, and the US - embedded structured incident management and blameless postmortem practices organisation-wide.
- Established chaos engineering practices using Keptn - identified fault scenarios, ran monthly game days, and hardened platform reliability against real-world failure conditions before they impacted production.

PLATFORM ENGINEERING & AUTOMATION

- Delivered CI/CD automation platform (modeas) handling 200+ builds per hour with feature flag-driven release controls - eliminated 10,000+ manual ops hours annually and accelerated deployment cadence by 600%.
- Drove Terraform IaC and AWS CDK/CloudFormation delivery for BMO: ECS Fargate and Lambda pipelines for .NET workloads with HA and DR architecture built in from day one; led AWS FinOps to reduce cloud waste.
- Designed GenAI risk-summarisation assistants on AWS Bedrock for BMO - enabled interactive Q&A via BCRG and LTS pipelines, reducing manual analysis effort at regulated-data scale.

TEAM BUILDING & LEADERSHIP

- Scaled ADP's SRE organisation from 4 to 40 engineers across India, Canada, and the US - hiring, onboarding, and engineering management structures across three geographies.
- Built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from the ground up, establishing foundational SRE practices, reliability reviews, and incident governance.
- Presented reliability strategies, SRE metrics, resiliency architectures, and incident outcomes directly to VP and C-suite stakeholders at ADP, Charles Schwab, and BMO.

Automation Technology Specialist

Jun 2018 - Sep 2020

IRIS Software | Toronto, Canada

Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance

- Established SRE principles within RBC's DevSecOps programme - introduced observability standards, incident classification frameworks, and reliability-focused deployment gates across 250+ applications.
- Inducted the DORA framework (Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, MTTR) across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance via Azure DevOps - drove measurable delivery performance improvements.
- Designed the Robo Deployment Framework - PowerShell-native CI/CD orchestration enabling self-service release pipelines; reduced application onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction).
- Led enterprise migration of 250+ applications across 60+ teams from CA SCM/Harvest to GitHub; enabled modern CI/CD and self-service provisioning at scale; contributed ~\$200K in new project acquisitions.

Automation Architect

Feb 2017 - Jun 2018

IRIS Software | Toronto, Canada

Clients: Insurance & Capital Markets

- Designed fault-tolerant, container-orchestrated deployment pipelines using Kubernetes and Helm - enabling zero-downtime rollouts across capital markets platforms.
- Led RPA practice delivery - automated 80+ applications and 250+ components across Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, and Mainframe stacks; closed \$478K SOW and enabled \$180K Capital Markets engagement.

Technology Manager

Jul 2015 - Feb 2017

TechMahindra Pvt. Ltd. | Noida, India

Client: Adobe Systems

- Led zero-downtime business application migration during Adobe's data centre relocation - owned full plan, execution, and cutover ensuring continuity across all production workloads.
- Executed Informatica-to-SQL Server migration and SAP HANA upgrades at enterprise scale; led cross-functional global engineering teams on large-scale delivery programmes.

Sr. SDET - QA, Automation & Production Engineering

Jul 2007 - Dec 2014

Microsoft Corporation | India

- Held dual mandate as Sr. SDET and Production Engineering owner - accountable for the complete quality and operational lifecycle of Sales & Marketing platforms serving US, EMEA, and APAC; sustained 99.99% uptime over 7 years.
- Owned all non-functional objectives (performance, availability, scalability, security) - defined and enforced standards across network, infrastructure, and application tiers.
- Built QA automation frameworks integrated with CI/CD pipelines - embedded automated regression and performance testing into release gates, eliminating manual bottlenecks.

Earlier Roles

2002 - 2015

Semantic Space Technologies | DRDO | NFC | India

- Semantic Space / Bank of America (2005-2007): Sole L3 Analyst for Statusmart (3,000+ users) - release management, DB and integration testing, SQL automation, incident resolution.
- DRDO / NFC (2002-2005): Systems development and optimisation for mission-critical defence applications requiring high reliability and security standards.

KEY PROJECTS

ADP SRE Observability & Reliability Transformation SRE

Full-stack observability (Prometheus + Grafana + Dynatrace + Splunk), SLI/SLO governance with error budgets, blameless postmortem culture, and chaos engineering via Keptn. Scaled SRE org from 4 to 40 engineers. Delivered 40%+ MTTR reduction through automated remediation and structured continuous improvement.

Prometheus | Grafana | Dynatrace | Splunk | Ansible | Python | Keptn | ServiceNow | AWS

modeas - High-Throughput CI/CD Platform PLATFORM

200+ builds/deployments per hour with feature flag-driven release controls and automated change evidence pipelines. Eliminated 10,000+ manual ops hours annually; 600% deployment cadence improvement. SOX-compliant audit trails and integrated quality gates.

Kubernetes | Helm | Jenkins | GitLab | Ansible | AWS ECS | Terraform | Feature Flags

Robo Deployment Framework (RBC Insurance) CI/CD

PowerShell-native self-service CI/CD orchestration for 250+ enterprise applications - reduced onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction).
SOX-compliant change evidence automation with SAST/DAST/IAST scanning integrated across Java and multi-stack workloads.

PowerShell | Python | GitHub Enterprise | Jenkins | UrbanCode | Ansible | SonarQube | JFrog

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence - Woolf University	2024
General Management Program (GMP) - ISB Hyderabad	2022
M.Sc in Computer Science - Osmania University	2002

CERTIFICATIONS

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| ♦ Certified SRE (iSRE) | ♦ Prometheus Certified Associate (PCA - CNCF) - 2026 |
| ♦ Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) - 2025 | ♦ AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (SAA-C01) - 2026 |
| ♦ Google Cloud Certified - Professional Cloud Architect - 2026 | ♦ Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) - 2026 |
| ♦ Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102) | ♦ Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Scientist Associate (DP-100) |
| ♦ ITIL® Certificate in IT Service Operations | ♦ PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP) |
| ♦ Microsoft Certified IT Professional (MCIT) | ♦ 6σ Yellow Belt (2016) |